

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 534

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Senator Frank Niceley for his distinguished, brilliant, and principled service as a member of the Tennessee General Assembly.

WHEREAS, it is most appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those fellow legislators who performed their duties with integrity and whose efforts during their time in office were dedicated to providing thoughtful service to their districts and to this great State; and

WHEREAS, Senator Frank Niceley of Strawberry Plains is one such distinguished public servant, who served both his constituency and this legislative body with honor and ability; and

WHEREAS, Senator Niceley is never afraid to speak truth, even when inconvenient, and often delivers it in a way that makes you laugh, learn, and then Google a few things afterward; and

WHEREAS, Frank Niceley always seems to know what is coming before the rest of us—perhaps from time travel, or good reading habits; and

WHEREAS, in a world where many talk but few truly listen or learn, Senator Niceley stands out for his brilliance, boldness, and boundless curiosity; and

WHEREAS, Senator Niceley served in the General Assembly for over two decades, championing small farms, low taxes, and Second Amendment rights, and he made it his mission to keep Tennessee strong enough to withstand another Depression—or at least a couple of bad federal policies; and

WHEREAS, Senator Niceley has always been an influential figure in the political, social, and civic life of his community, and he served his constituents in numerous capacities during his twenty-four-year tenure on Capitol Hill; and

WHEREAS, unafraid to challenge the establishment, he once lost reelection after refusing to support a permanent tax increase, proving that he was more interested in doing what was right than what was easy; and

WHEREAS, Frank Niceley ably represented the 35th District in the House of Representatives during the 96th and 97th General Assemblies and the 17th House District during the 104th through 107th General Assemblies, serving as chair of the House Agriculture Committee during his last term; and

WHEREAS, in 2012, Mr. Niceley ascended to the upper chamber of the General Assembly and served three terms in the Senate during the 108th through 113th General Assemblies, rendering sterling service as 2nd vice chair of the body's Transportation and Safety Committee and as a member of its Energy, Agriculture and Natural Resources Committee; and

WHEREAS, Frank Niceley was a tremendous asset for the good people of Claiborne, Grainger, Hancock, Jefferson, Union, and Sevier counties in the Senate, working with purpose and commitment to protect family farms and increase their profitability, ensure fiscal responsibility in State government, maintain low taxes, fight federal government overreach, and make Tennessee the best place to live and raise a family; and

WHEREAS, Senator Niceley's life and family history are deeply embedded in East Tennessee; he is the direct descendent of five veterans of the Revolutionary War, all of whom are buried in the 8th Senate District he represented, and one of these ancestors was the doorkeeper to the first Tennessee General Assembly that established our State; and

WHEREAS, Frank Niceley and his wife, Cyndie, make their home on 400 acres along the Holston River in Jefferson County; their Riverplains Farm is a working farm that includes row crops, livestock, and an active equestrian training center; and

WHEREAS, Senator Frank Niceley is committed to the precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be recognized upon his tenure in the General Assembly; and

WHEREAS, his deep love of Tennessee history, his commitment to principled leadership, his ability to educate his colleagues with the vigor of a university professor and the flair of a front-porch philosopher, and his one-of-a-kind personality have earned him not only the unofficial title of "Senate Historian," but also the very official respect of this General Assembly; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Senator Frank Niceley for his meritorious service to Tennessee, his countless contributions and many good works in service of the residents of the 8th Senate District, and for making legislative sessions both smarter and far more interesting. We commend him for his years of advocacy, wit, and wisdom, and extend to him our sincerest best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.